

Ancient remedies

Before the age of science, people used all sorts of weird and wacky remedies to try and cure diseases. Many people visited witch doctors or priests in search of magical cures. Others made their own medicines, following traditional old wives' recipes. Many of the ancient remedies were useless or even dangerous, but a few really did work and are still used today.

WOW!

People used to think diseases were spread by foul smells. Powerful perfumes were used to ward off illness.



HERBAL MEDICINE

Plants have been used as medicines all over the world for thousands of years and they are still popular today. Some of our modern drugs were discovered thanks to ancient herbal remedies. The painkiller aspirin, for instance, comes from the bark of willow trees, which people once used to make a pain-relieving tea.

► BROKEN ARM

This engraving from the 1500s shows how a man's broken arm was treated. Turning the screw pulled the arm straight, moving the broken bones back into position.

